paved the way for the launching of military operation *Rah-e-Nijat* against the militants in Swat.

In the case of TTP, it is true that 'the media is the terrorist's best friend', or 'publicity is the oxygen all terrorists need'. It thrives on the fear created by the media coverage to its terrorist acts. Maulvi Fazlullah, Chief of TTP Swat chapter, used an FM radio station to propagate his views to threaten people and the government. He used it so persistently and effectively that he was nicknamed Maulvi FM. However, after military operation Rah-e-Nijat, these elements spread and their FM radio broadcasts came to a halt. There had been indications that after a lull of three years, the Swati Taliban had again started their radio broadcasts. 'After relative peace since 2009, the Taliban are back in Swat Valley – at least on the air waves' (*The Express Tribune*, 2012). Richard Holbrooke, who was America's envoy to Afghanistan and Pakistan, stated in 2009 that 'Fazlullah is going round every night broadcasting the names of people they are going to behead or have beheaded. Any of you who have a recent sense of history will know that that's exactly what happened with Radio Mille Collines in Rwanda'. Radio Mille Collines (Thousand Hills Radio) seemed to be directing the massacres in the Rwandan genocide of 1994. It not only poisoned the general atmosphere, but also urged on the killers, with phrases like 'cutting the tall trees' and 'killing the cockroaches' (*The Economist*, 2009). Holbrooke emphasised that broadcasting was one area where lessons learned in one war zone must be transferred to others. Hezbollah had also used radio and television to broadcast its point of view and to 'bolster terrorism'. PKK also ran a satellite television, which 'proved to be one of the most important consciousness-raising instruments at the disposal of PKK'.

As far as use of FM radios or portable transmitters by Pakistani insurgents is concerned, a local analyst was of the view that the only antidote to hate radio was rival FM transmissions, run by locals who could speak familiar dialects and catered to local interests, from farming to music (*The Economist*, 2009). It meant a counter-propaganda campaign was essential. But in addition to it, continuous campaign to jam the transmissions of ever-popping transmitters was equally important.

The TTP interacted with the media like a political party. Its spokespersons were actively engaged with the media and issued statements, usually to accept the responsibility of any terrorist attack. At times, they gave policy statements as well. Ehsanullah Ehsan had